

THE PARTING

Outside, the calm of humid summer day,
Within, the strain of parting. Loving twain;
That day his last, she trying to be gay—
To let him know her loss was freedom's gain.

Could she exist without this man? Her own,
More closely bound then merely earthly
ties—

Her life with him, — blessings of heaven
blown

Essence, of something far beyond the skies!

He was a man. You say he could not feel
The loss in leaving her whom he adored?
Marriage! Her love! Their life which was so
real

Now put behind him. Down tyranny! Up
sword!

Then he was gone and she found quick re-
lease,

As every woman does at such an hour.
The flood of tears brought emotional sur-
cease,

And from a higher strength came quiet
power.

—By Alden W. Kelly, Madison, Wis.

Mom, this is one that I wrote to Evie when she was feeling that our move to New Mexico was almost too much.

In Future, Hope
by Awk.

Still broad horizons loom which menace not,
Nor poor appear from our sequestered spot.

Rise to the hope of challenge yet away,
In timorous heart bid courage welcome, stay!

Hold proud thy head; to stronger future cast
A tie, a prayer, nor linger in the past.

Let thy mem'ry recall but pleasantness,-
Blight not what comes, but softly lend carress;

That thou and I though future seem unclear,
May pass therein, have each,- and so no fear!

"Our Love is Young"

A. W. K.

Our love is young,-O'er stress of age that hues
And hides to other eyes the youth we were:
How young our love? - nor icy winds can lose
Tremulous lips,- the passion that you stir.

Dear heart of mine, that was and is fore'er;
Climactic need of man from birth to end,
My own, thou art the one my soul finds fair;
Our love is young, no need therein pretend.

If else it were then young to me, my heart,
I would alas, be perforce then unborn.
When love's not young far better ban the start!
Keep young our love to greet the blessed morn.

"MAKE TRUE THE COURSE"

BY ALDEN W. KELLY, MADISON, WIS.

THE COURSE WAS SET ONE DAY WHEN ALL WAS CALM,
NO WAVES TOO HIGH NOR SUN THAT BURNED TOO DEEP.
ON MINOR HURTS WE USED CURATIVE BALM;
THOUGH EASY TROD, WE THOUGHT THE HILLS TOO STEEP.

THAT DAY THE ROAD AND GOAL, HOW SIMPLY SEEN:
TO SCHOOL TO HIGHER ARTS, THEN WED, AND WORK
THE SPAN WE MAY:- SO EXIT FROM THE SCENE,
REPLACED BY OTHERS COME FROM OUT THE MURK.

HOW NOW WE BLINDLY HUNT THE WAY WE KNEW,
OUR VISION SHORT, SCARRED HANDS, A BLEEDING HEART
STILL HOPE EXPRESS, THOUGH NEVER AID IN VIEW.
SO, GRIMLY HOLD, NOR HIGHER AIM DEPART.

SOME DAY AT LAST, SECURE PEACE SHALL RAISE
A TENDER HAND, CLEAR SIGHT AND HEAL THOSE SORES.
THAT HEART WHICH LOST, TIME BRINGS FROM OUT THE HAZE,
AND FERVENT PRAYERS GIVE THANKS FOR END OF WARS.

" PARENTAL PROBLEMS "

BY A. W. KELLY, AUG. 10, 1943

A FLOOD OF JOY, SO EASILY PERCEIVED,
IN EVERY MOTION, WORD AND HAPPY GLANCE.
HER THRILL OF LIFE SCARCELY CAN BE BELIEVED,
SO FULLY THINGS AND MOMENTS HELP ENHANCE
EXISTANCE HERE. SHE DOESN'T FEEL DECEIVED.
SHE BARKS AT DOGS AND PULLS UP MOTHER'S PLANTS.
THEN TOO, SOMETIMES SHE HAS TO BE RELIEVED
OF KNIVES OR FORKS, YET TAKES AN ADULT'S GRANTS
GRATEFULLY, WITHOUT BEING TOO AGRIEVED
APPARENTLY. SHE TAKES AN AWKWARD STANCE
STILL, WHILE WALKING, A WORSE CAN'T BE CONCEIVED,
YET IT'S EFFECTIVE, - MAKES HER DADDY DANCE
AT PLAYTIME. THEN EATS - FINALLY SHE'S HEAVED
IN BED AND PARENTS COME OUT OF THEIR TRANCE
UNTIL NEXT MORNING.

"Dark Night of Fear"

AWK.

November 7, 1945

Dark night, who finds the orphan cold,
Nor restful place therein for him,
Abate the ills, in comfort fold
The mortal's wish though lighted dim,
That he may savor good.

What then dark night, great fearful beast,
Who lags to leap in peril strange;
Allay such fears, provide the least
Harshness for them, let terrors change,
To bring the calm you could.

So night or ill and dark despite
Provide an ebon haven, turn
To bring at end of day respite;
The relaxation that men earn
Is theirs, dispel it not.

This night let fall protective hope
Which succors all and rests the heart,
So men refreshed may next day cope
With world's affairs, nor lose their part.
Give faith,- improve their lot!

In Anticipation

By AWK.

Let fate not interrupt the one we are
Who seeks the light of day within thy womb,
For in that yet unborn we stand afar,-
In ages hence lie deathless in the tomb.

That we by love may thus be interspersed
Through eons yet to come, nor earth forego,-
Again to live!- the deathly ties dispersed;
To die, how then? our blood in this we sow.

Yet guard thou well, that we lose not our key
Of way to future, linked through us to past,
That from thyself ere long there issues free
A being wholly us, whom we have cast!

Dream too thy hopes in silence if desire,
Or give thy wish a voice that I may feel
Thy conscious longing and the mental fire,
What fears bespeak?- or venture the ideal.

To trust, to believe, and fright at naught to come,
Te'er appears in thoughtful imagery;
Truth not phantoms dark, take comfort from
Face, to stand as rugged base of tree!

Our Due

A. W. Kelly

Within a realm of trees and liquid lines
That mark the edge and surface of a lake,
We made our home and knew all nature's signs,
Yet more than our just due we would not take.

Was our due just ? The love we bore for each,
The life we knew, - Ourselves had built by hand.
Wordless Nature! We heard the words she'd preach.
For devotees she had no reprimand.

Yes, life was good, though wealth came not our way.
We knew no envy, our riches well we saw -
Our friends, our God, our baby too one day.
Our private world was surely without flaw.

Then - the drummings of vast catastrophe!
The steady throbbing tread of marching men.
Once more the call to arms to keep us free,
America needs her sons yet again.

And what of us? Our country asks its due
To overcome the ones who demand all.
The army needs its men, each ship a crew.
We'll all help build an Axis wailing wall!

" THIS SINGING WORLD "

BY A. W. KELLY, AUG. 10, 1943

LIST TO HARMONIC VOICES
THAT SING FROM OUT THE EARTH.
THE BIRDS CALL MATES, THEIR CHOICES,
GIVE HEARTFELT SONGS OF BIRTH!

THE WINDS THAT SING AND CARRY
KIND NATURE'S PERFUME FAR,
TO LISTENING EARS SOUND MERRY,
WHILE CLOUDS SING PAST A STAR.

GREEN LEAVES DANCING IN THE BREEZE,
STEMS AND BLADES A-QUIVER,
REFLECT THE SINGING OF THE TREES-
ECHOED FROM THE RIVER.

NATURE SINGS A SONG OF LIFE,
AWAKE AND GAILY FAIR,
SONGS OF HAPPINESS THAT'S RIFE,-
ARE YOU OF SONGS AWARE?

" WE SOAR AFAR "

A. W. KELLY, AUG. 9, 1943

WITHIN, RELEASE - NO EARTHLY BONDS OR TIES,
SAVE ONLY THOSE WE WISH TO YET RETAIN,
WE LEAP TO HEIGHTS ABOVE THIS WORLD'S SKIES,
OUR WISHFUL SOUL DOTH FREEDOM SURE OBTAIN.

HOW QUICKLY THEN ONE LEAVES THE COMMONPLACE
TO JOIN THE WINDS AS THEY WHISK THROUGH THE CLOUDS.
WITHOUT THE EARTH, HOW RAPID IS THE PACE -
MOUNTAINS FAR BELOW, WRAPPED UP IN THEIR SHROUDS.

NO FEELING THERE OF FRIENDLINESS OR HURT,
ONLY THE CALM, SWIFT MOVING UNIVERSE,-
QUITE CLOSE IT SEEMS TO HEM OF SACRED SKIRT,-
THERE, VOICES, VERY SWEET, NOT HARD NOR TERSE.

SMALL WONDER THEN WE SEEK ESCAPE WITHIN!
IMAGINATION SURELY CUTS OUR CHAINS -
WE'RE SHACKLE-FREE TO DREAM WHAT MIGHT HAVE BEEN,
THEN, BACK TO EARTH,- SUBCONSCIOUS THINKING WANES.

"IN HOPE IS STRENGTH"

BY ALDEN W. KELLY

THOU, STRENGTH OF HOPE, THAT FILLS
THE FUTURE'S RADIANT GLOW,
OUR HELP ON PRESENT HILLS,
WHO SMOOTHS THE RAPIDS FLOW;

AID EARTHLY TO ASPIRE
WITH MINDS UNFETTERED, CALM,
YET GLOWING INNER FIRE
TO EARN THE VICTOR'S PALM.

FOR THOSE WHO SUFFER,- GIVE
THY STRONG SUPPORT AND CHEER;
BESTOW THY WILL TO LIVE,
PROTECT FROM UNKNOWN FEAR;

EXALT THE CHILDREN'S SIGHT
TO VERIFY THE TRUTH
THAT OUTLOOK MUST BE BRIGHT,
OUR LIVING NOT UNCOUTH.

THESE STRENGTHS I ASK FOR MEN,
WHEN E'ER THE NEED ARISE,
FOR BIRTH OF HOPE AGAIN
WITHIN A SOUL THAT DIES!